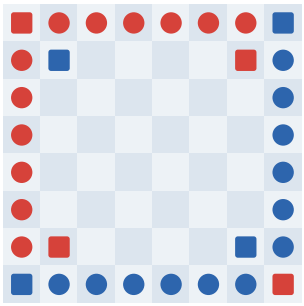
Lipfty 18 — How to play

Experimental gameplay candidate v18.0.5. Neither player owns a playing colour. The opponent normally chooses which ordinary reserve colour you must use.

1. Board and preparation

The inner 6 × 6 has four permanently pinned Opening Four pieces on its inner corners: equal colours on opposite diagonals. They count towards four-piece patterns from the start. Arrange 24 ordinary reserves (12 of each colour) around the non-corner outside edges. The four outer physical corners start with two special pieces of each colour.



4 pinned opening anchors

24 ordinary reserves

4 outer specials — 2 per colour

One opposite-colour special each

2. Starting the game and the corners

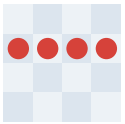
Choose a starting colour-chooser. That player selects an ordinary reserve piece/colour for the opponent, who becomes the first ordinary placer. The first placer automatically holds a matching-colour special from an outside corner, and the starting chooser automatically holds a special of the opposite colour. No separate corner-piece choice is made. The other two specials remain in their outside corners. The first ordinary placer places the handed ordinary piece on an empty inner square. The chooser then selects Accept (take the next turn) or Take position (the original placer continues). A Take never moves the first placed piece, and neither Accept nor Take changes either player's assigned special colour. Neither player owns a shared playing colour.

3. The compulsory Move/Jump qualification

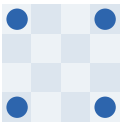
Each player must successfully perform at least one Move or Jump before they may win. The first Move/Jump immediately qualifies that player. Complete the original two compulsory placements if the action did not end the game, then return that player's held special piece to any empty outside corner. That return does not use an ordinary reserve and does not enter the 6 × 6. Any successful winning Move/Jump ends immediately; its corner is returned automatically. A player may perform further Moves and Jumps as often as legal. Ordinary placement alone never fulfils the requirement.

4. How to win

A qualified player wins by completing four same-colour pieces horizontally, vertically or diagonally. Standard additionally allows tight and spaced axis-aligned squares. Both colours are shared. The opponent need not have completed their own qualification. A four-piece pattern created by an unqualified player does not win; play continues. A win cancels any remaining compulsory placements.



Line: all versions



Square: Standard

5. Ordinary turn — Place, Move or Jump

The opponent selects an available ordinary reserve colour, which the active player may Place on any empty inner square. Alternatively in Easy and Standard the active player may Move an eligible unpinned board piece of that colour one adjacent square, including diagonally, or Jump over an adjacent opposite-colour, unpinned piece to the empty square beyond. The moved/jumped piece receives temporary protection. Opening Four pieces are permanently pinned and cannot be jumped over.

6. Consequence after a Move

If the Move does not immediately win, the opponent first chooses and places another ordinary reserve piece. The mover then places the exact originally handed piece. The held reserve is not available to the responding player. Move requires another unreserved ordinary piece to be available. If this was the mover's first Move/Jump, the mover then returns their held outside special.

Then TWO placements

Opponent first; mover second

Hold the selected reserve until its placement.

7. Consequence after a Jump

If the Jump does not immediately win, the jumped piece is removed temporarily. The opponent chooses which of the exact jumped or handed pieces to place, then the jumper places the other. The two exact pieces must be preserved. This follows the v13.0.4 source rule, not the earlier printed example. After those placements, the first-time jumper returns their held outside special. A winning placement cancels what remains of the sequence.

Then TWO placements

Opponent first; mover second

Jumped Blue is redeployed.

8. Deadline when a reserve colour runs out

After completing any compulsory placement/return sequence, when either ordinary reserve colour first has no remaining pieces, qualification is checked. If exactly one player is unqualified, that player loses immediately. If neither player has qualified, the first ordinary placer loses, as they had the first chance to act. If both are qualified, play continues, but ordinary turns become Place only. This rule is deliberate: a player cannot avoid Move/Jump indefinitely.

9. Final Four and draws

When all ordinary reserves have been placed without a win, the four special pieces occupy the outside corners. Players then choose one outside special on their own turn and Place it on any empty inner 6 × 6 square. Specials are permanently pinned once played. There are no Moves or Jumps during Final Four. If all four enter play without a win, the game is drawn.

10. Matches and settings

Single game, Best of 3, or Best of 5, with alternating starting colour-choosers. Match counters are separate from gameplay specials. A draw earns no match point and the game is replayed. Undo, clock, colours, sound, statistics, offline play and other existing game features are retained. Learning (Place-only) is not offered in this experimental candidate because qualifying Move/Jump would be impossible.